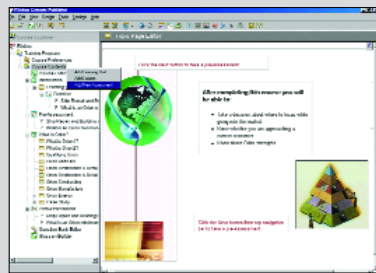


Elicitus - An e-learning tool

First launched in 1994, Elicitus is an e-learning tool designed, developed and maintained by Harbinger Knowledge Products. Presently deployed in over eight countries including US, UK and Japan ELICITUS is a desktop authoring tool, designed keeping the subject matter expert and the trainer in mind. ELICITUS does not require any programming knowledge to develop e-Learning courses. It provides readymade e-Learning components such as learning hierarchy (Learning units, lessons and topics), course navigation, global course settings, assessments and glossary.

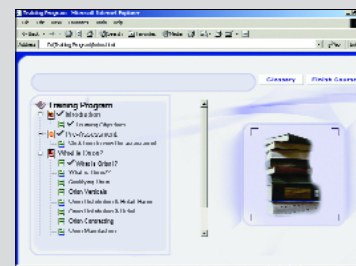


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All the topics can be developed using a library of over 200 built-in authoring templates. These templates have the facility to embed text, graphics, videos, pictures, animations and voiceovers. To this framework one can add assessment using the built-in assessment

engine. It supports six different question types namely, multiple choice single correct answer, multiple choice multiple correct answers, true / false, fill in the blanks, match the pair and graphic choice. The assessments can either be integrated as a lesson under a learning unit or as a quick exercise under a topic.

ELICITUS also provides a built-in glossary engine which helps the author to support the course with many reference text and complimentary learning material. This enables the author to focus on the actual course content and depending on the learner's competency; one can refer to additional content if required. ELICITUS offers a comprehensive import facility. This helps multiple authors to author different parts of a course. Once authored, all these parts can be imported in one single course. This helps in increasing productivity and reduces authoring time.



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experts is a powerful and highly effective tool. MBT's Login2Learn framework facilitates the creation and management of such a customized learning environment.

Login2Learn is an integration of various type of course material in hypertext, plain text files, presentation slides and PDF documents, with or without multimedia. It has the facility to stream audio and video. It enables interaction with faculty and experts through chat forums and via e-mail. A bank of FAQ's are created and maintained for helping students. Question banks and question papers are also available for online examinations. Progress of students is tracked by constant monitoring and their feedback is automatically evaluated.

Another business using e-learning to its advantage is the stock broking company, Sharekhan. Being in the retail broking industry, it has to be constantly updated about what is happening in the share market, as customers purchasing shares approach them for assistance. With more than 220 outlets across the country, being in touch and updated is very essential. Sharekhan uses e-learning to improve the efficiency of its people. E-learning is mainly used in Sharekhan by the research team and equity sales team.

The research team is one of the main drivers of this organization. They have to constantly study the stock market, analyse trends, etc. With the basic question, 'What is happening in the market?' it is very important for the Sharekhan team to be updated with sundry information in order to give its customers a satisfactory answer. 'We have to be well informed about the market. We also have try and understand the logic behind market and research helps us in doing that,' says a senior official at Sharekhan.

Sharekhan uses Enterprise Communication Platform (ECP) - an e-learning package developed by Satyam CA. The research team has to communicate its findings across all the Sharekhan outlets in the country. Earlier when an e-mail

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was the only avenue, this was not very interactive. E-learning on the other hand helps make the whole process of information sharing very interactive. Video conferencing is used to accompany delivery of information. This kind of learning helps both the trainer and the person receiving the information. ECP helps the Sharekhan team to track the attendance automatically once a person logs in (or fails to). 'Feedback to the trainer is direct and there is much better control overall. Dissemination of knowledge becomes much easier,' adds the official.

When an organisation grows, synchronising information across its girth becomes difficult. Organising classroom training in such a case become impractical. In such a scenario, e-learning is one of the most effective tools available today.

ECP enables learning to happen on a real-time basis. Presentations to clients, servicing the clients, are other areas that have become simpler because of e-learning. Mr. Arora says that benefits are very subjective and more in terms of quality than quantity. Increase in productivity, client acquisition is some of the other areas which have benefited.

What is in store?

Traditional classroom teaching will never go out of fashion but e-learning is fast catching up and is attracting a lot of believers. Vendors need to work with their customers to help them identify, understand, and apply best practices to ensure that their e-learning initiatives are successful. More importantly, you as a company should communicate with both your employees and content providers to understand the needs of your staff and how to best enhance their knowledge.

As a company, it is vital to use technology to share information. As Bill Gates once put it, 'Power comes not from knowledge kept but from knowledge shared.' A good e-learning tool can help your company do just that. ■

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